KU LEUVEN

Semester 2:

Business case
From tomatoes to business

EE3 EM Mechatronics – 2025-’26

Professional competences – semester 2

Focus on:

- Project management
- Team dynamics
- Scientific writing
- Persuasive communication

Activities:

1. **Business case**
2. **Presentation to pre-bachelors**

1 Business case: from tomatoes to business

HAVE: Great idea and a solid design

NEED: Clear business case to succeed

- Why your solution matters?
- Who will buy it?
- How it is porfitable?
- ...

1 Business case: from tomatoes to business

Deliverables:

Paper

1. Business case report
2. Scientific report about a technical asset

Poster fair

3. Pitch your robotic arm concept at the European Agro-Tech Innovation Fair 2026 (EATIF)

1. Business case report

Business case

- **The case**
- Explains why a project should be done
- Shows the problem, the proposed solution, benefits, costs, and risks
- Goal: help decision-makers see if the project is worth it

- **The report**
  - Executive Summary
  - Background & Problem Statement
  - Objectives & Scope
  - Proposed Solution
  - Cost-Benefit Analysis
  - Risk Analysis & Mitigation
  - Implementation Plan
  - Conclusion & Recommendation

2. Scientific report about a technical asset

Technical asset

Choose **one asset** that is unique or interesting to your design. Highlight its importance and development through scientific writing (using the IMRaD structure)

Scientific writing

Three sessions on scientific writing to review the foundations

Consult materials posted on Toledo + *faculty vademecum* already! Useful for all your reports this semester!

Deliverables

GOAL: 1800–2000-word report on your chosen asset

DUE: **Tuesday, May 19th**

EVALUATION: across four foundations of scientific writing

3. Poster session

- **19/05 Atrium Group T**
  - Bridge engineering and entrepreneurship
  - Create a poster
  - Pitch you design to farmers, investors and the future of sustainable food production

Mark your agenda!

Planning

Session 1	Session 2	Session 3	Session 4	Session 5
21/4	28/4	5/5	12/5	19/5

EUROPEAN AGRO-TECH INNOVATION FAIR 2026

Session 1 to 4

- content-related explanation
- working time

Session 5

- Poster fair + deadline reports

Evaluation

Deadline : 19 May 2026

Poster Session – AgroFair
(1/4 of the total points)

Report
1. **Business Case report** – fully developed using the provided template
(2/4 of the total points)
2. **Scientific report on Technical Asset** – one aspect of their project highlighted through scientific writing
(1/4 of the total points)

Presentation to pre-bachelors

1 bonus point

1. Business case report

9 topics

4 weeks

A business case report is a document that explains **why a project or idea is worth pursuing**

- → Supports decision-making
- → Shows value and feasibility

→ Free choice in layout

1. Business case report

9 topics

WEEK 1

1. Executive Summary Introduction

Provide a concise overview of the business case

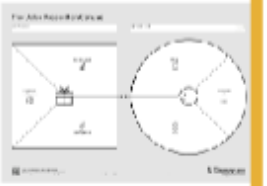
Explain the context and purpose of this business case

2.Technical Solution Overview

Describe the robotic arm system

3.Value Proposition & USP

Value Proposition Canvas diagram



WEEK 2

4.Business Model Canvas

Visual BMC layout

5.Market Analysis

Target market size and growth trends.

Customer personas.

WEEK 3

6.Financial Feasibility

Initial investment estimate.

Breakeven point and ROI projections.

Cost-benefit analysis.

WEEK 4

7.Implementation Roadmap

Key milestones and timeline.

Risk management plan.

8.The Team

Roles and responsibilities.

9.Conclusion

Strategic fit.

1. Business case report

WEEK 1

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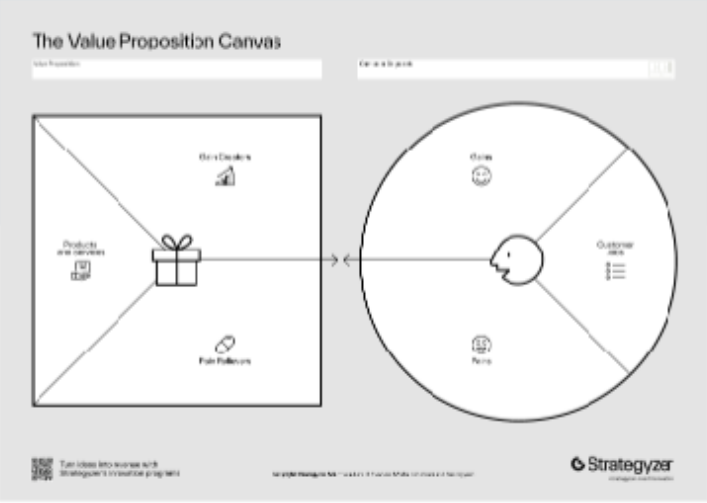


1. Business case report

1. Executive Summary
Introduction

Provide a concise overview of the business case

Explain the context and purpose of this business case

Translates into following

We developed a solution for ...
The problem we solve is ...
Our solution works by ...
This is important because ...

1. Business case report

2.Technical Solution Overview

Describe the robotic arm system

Translates into following

How does it work?
- Use the final report as a base
- Include the most relevant topics

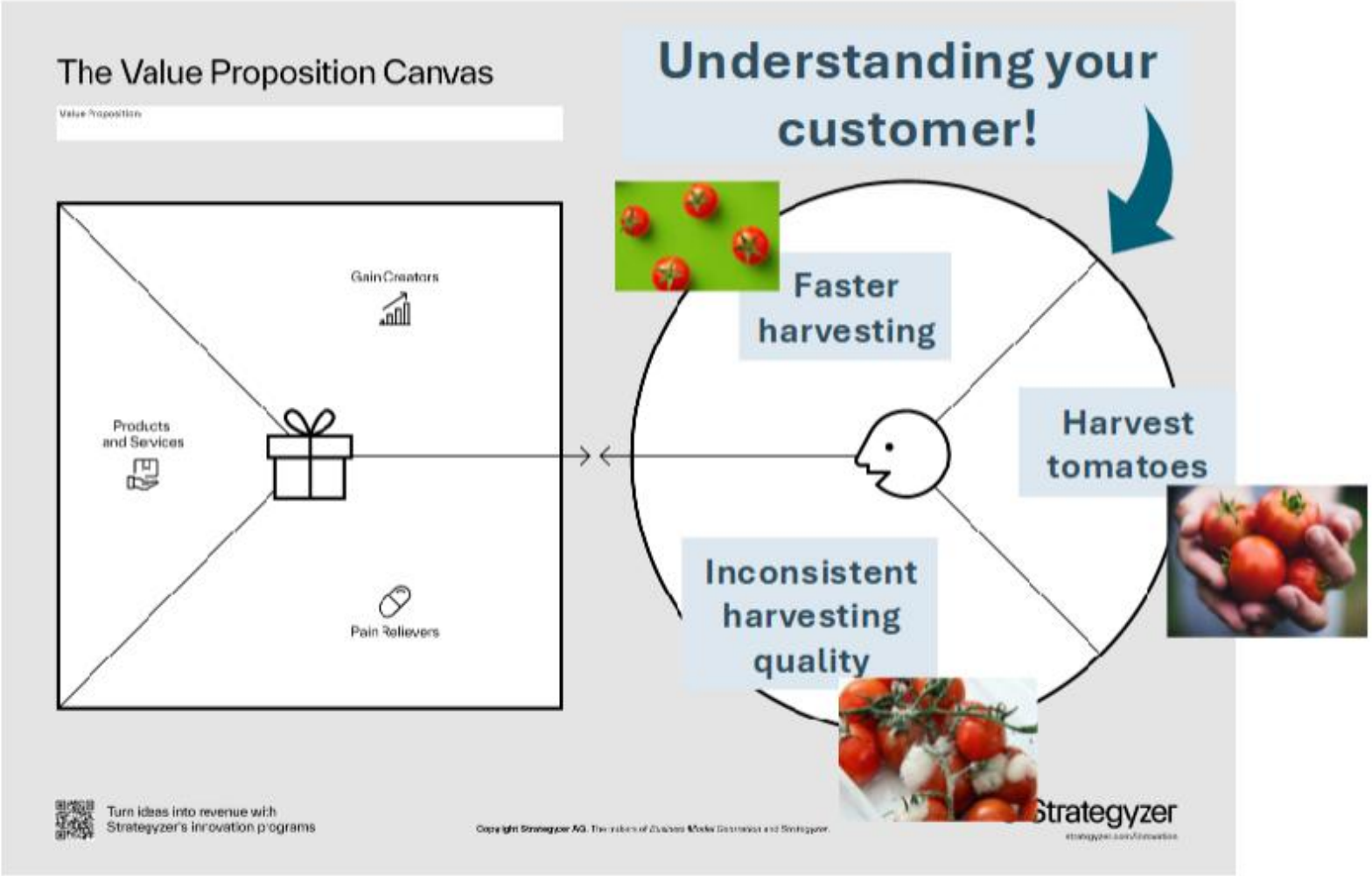
Include sketches !

Scientific report about a technical asset

1. Business case report

3.Value Proposition & USP

Value Proposition Canvas diagram



1. Business case report

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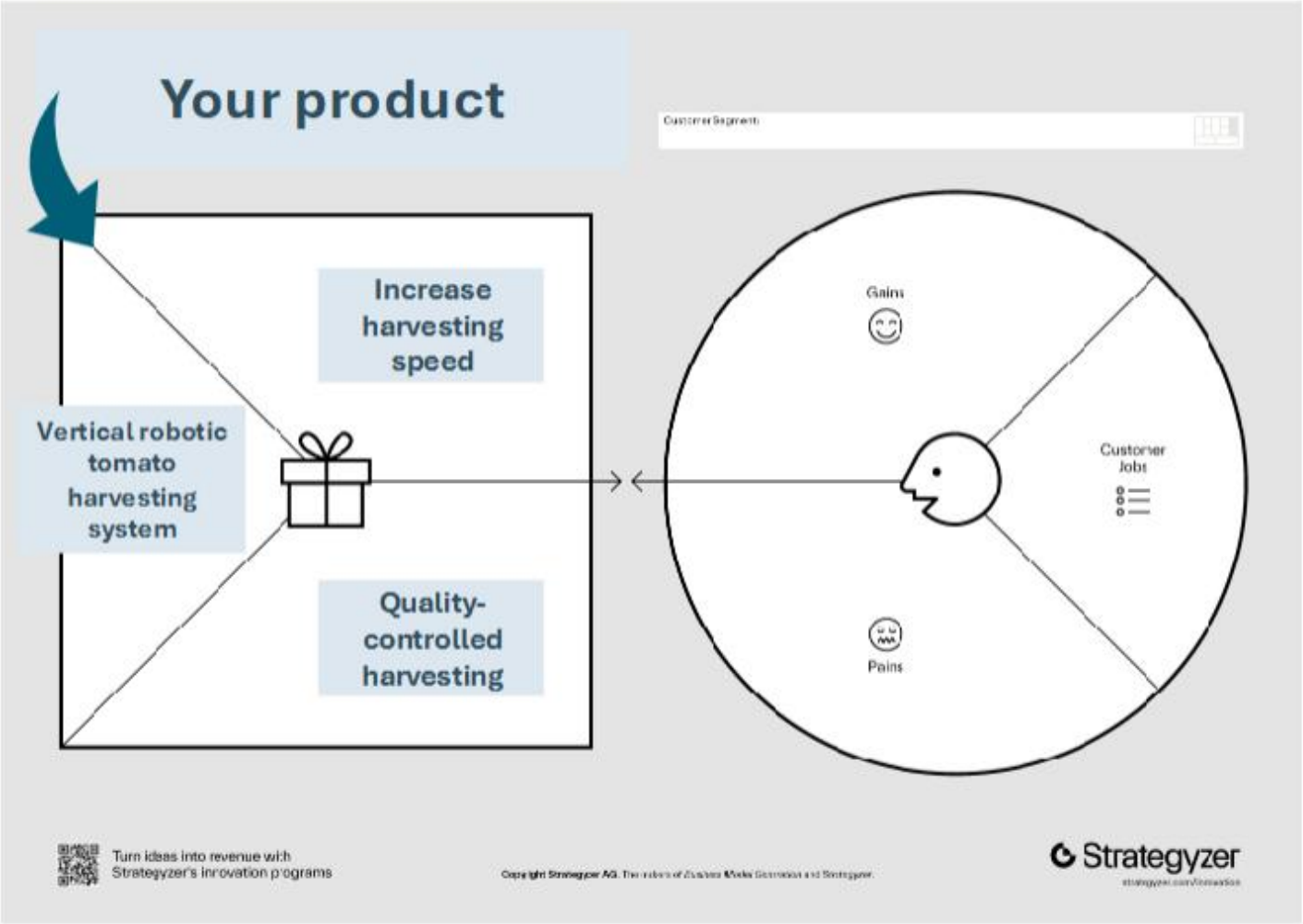
Value Proposition Canvas diagram



1. Business case report

3.Value Proposition & USP

Value Proposition Canvas diagram

START WITH THIS TOPIC

1. Business case report

How can you translate this to the poster?

Next steps

- Start writing your business case report
  - 1.Executive Summary Introduction
    - **Using the questions and your report**
  - 2.Technical Solution Overview
    - **Including a sketch**
  - 3.Value Proposition & USP
    - **Using the Value Proposition Canvas diagram**
    - **Get at least two matches (besides the one shown)**

Start with

An accompanying tekst (+/- 800 words)

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Questions?